The Seussification of Romeo and Juliet

By Peter Bloedel

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles: ***Actor 1:*** *Narrator 1; Prologue; Romeo baby; Pregnant Lady Capitulate; Paris; Servant; Romeo, The Prince; Monk Larry in scene with Juliet, Monotone*

Actor 2: *Narrator 2; Pregnant Lady Monotone, Juliet baby; Capitulate; Benvolio; Juliet; Nurse; Tybalt; Monk Larry in scene with Romeo; Mercutio; Lady Capitulate*

NARRATOR 1: Dear Ladies and Menfolk!

NARRATOR 2: Women and Gents!

NARRATOR 1: You're people of culture and true common sense.

NARRATOR 2: You know what you know, and you like what you like.

NARRATOR 1: Like singing a song or riding a bike.

NARRATOR 2: We like that stuff too!

NARRATOR 1: It's the greatest!

NARRATOR 2: You bet!

NARRATOR 1: And topping the list ...

BOTH: Romeo and Juliet.

NARRATOR 2: The play is just perfect.

NARRATOR 1: Nothing is wrong.

NARRATOR 2: Except that it's almost two hours . . .

BOTH: *(Glancing at each other and then to the audience)* Too Long!

NARRATOR 2: We've shortened the play, changed some names, made it rhyme
No more of that blank verse, we don't think he'd mind.

NARRATOR 1: [*(whispers)* Shakespeare]

INTRODUCTION

TOGETHER: The Seussification of Romeo and Juliet by Peter Bloedel

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PROLOGUE: Verona's the place from where our play is picked. Two families lived there, and man were they ticked. Straight from the loins of those mentioned above . . . *(Lady Monotone enters visibly pregnant)* Popped kid one ... *(Popping sound. ROMEO pops out, crying and sucking on his thumb. His mother is now visibly NOT pregnant.)* And kid two . . . *(Popping sound. JULIET pops out crying and sucking her thumb. Her mother is now visibly not pregnant.)* And they fell in love. *(Romeo and Juliet look lovingly at each other and stop crying)*

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NARRATOR 2: Meanwhile at the Capitulate pad, There's a suitor for Julie and he's with her dad.

PARIS: Capitulate! I am the man for your daughter.

CAPITULATE: I don't think you'll do.

PARIS: But who could be hotter? Besides that, I brought you some peppermint candy.

CAPITULATE: *(To the SERVANT)* Does he have a point? *(The SERVANT nods.) (To Paris)* I think you'll be dandy. Let's have a banquet. *(To the SERVANT)* Young man go and get all of these people whose names I have writ. *(CAPITULATE hands an invitation list to the SERVANT and then exits with PARIS.)*

SERVANT: Before I can find all the people and greet 'em, I need to find help from someone who can read 'em.

BENVOLIO: *(Interrupting him)* Hey buddy! What's up? Can we help you there?

SERVANT: Sure enough, if there is help then I need it, 'cuz I've got this list here, and I just can't read it. To find a strong reader is what I've been hoping . . .

ROMEO: *(Taking the list)* I'll read it to you, it will keep me from moping. *(He reads)* These folks can come to Capitulate's party: Smarty Martino and his boy named Arty, Bronco Buck Billy, and Buck Billy Buff, And Lady McDinky, McDucky, McDuff // Dave from Topeka, and Lady Von Rybald, Rosaline, Valentine, Livia, Tybalt, Anyone named Gordie or Tim or Melissa, Can come to this bash, if you can't

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then we'll miss ya. *(Finished reading, he says to SERVANT)* This party sound great.

******* Suddenly we're at the party *******

(Romeo dances, then notices JULIET)

ROMEO: Ei-hotchee-mama, Growl, Whoo! Hubba-hubba! That girl is a babe or my name is dumb hubba. *(ROMEO pulls his visor down over his eyes to conceal his identity, he goes to JULIET and commences flirting.)* Please, don't think I'm forward, but I think you're hot! *(An alarm goes off TYBALT rushes down stage from the party group.)*

TYBALT: *(to audience)* My Monotone alarm just gave the alert! I keep it hidden right here in my shirt. It detects Monotones. It's never wrong. And this one is foolin' where he don't belong.

JULIET: *(Aside)* I can't see his face is it worth it or not? *(ROMEO lifts his visor and leans in for a kiss)* Hey, you're kind of cute, okay, here, hold my gum first. It's raspberry, lima bean, sneezle fruit, bratwurst. *(They kiss.)*

ROMEO: Wow! Hey, you're right, that is good tasting gum.

NURSE: *(Enters and says to Juliet)* Your mother would like a few words with you, hon. *(Juliet exits)*

ROMEO: Who is her Mom, if I may be so bold? Quickly, please tell me before I get old.

NURSE: Her Dad is the host, who bought that main course dish you ate. Her Mother's no other than Lady Capitulate. Juliet is her name and she is the fairest. But don't get ideas. She's marrying Paris. *(Romeo's excitement is crushed)*

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NARRATOR 1: Needless to say Romy's heart-ache was done. He met a new girl and she had good gum. *(JULIET enters aloft)* All of the guests from the banquet had parted, But not Romeo, he was just getting started. *(Romeo enters and spies Juliet aloft)*

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JULIET: Romeo baby-o, baby-o, buff! Wherefore art thou, I just can't get enough.

ROMEO: Oh, Juliet, you're a pearl of great price. You're like two pearls only much, much, more nice.

JULIET: Let's find the preacher!

ROMEO: Let's get hitched tomorrow. Enough of this fighting . . .

JULIET: . . . This feuding . . .

BOTH: This sorrow. *(They run away blowing kisses to each other.)*

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NARRATOR 2: So Romeo ran to the home of Monk Larry, Not monkey Larry ... he's not quite that hairy, He's just a monk, he's the monkiest one That Romeo knew and could get the job done. *(Enter ROMEO.)*

ROMEO: Oh good! Monk Larry! I'm glad that you're here.

MONK LARRY: *(In a Bronx accent)* Where else would I be, I've not left here in years. How can I help you, my dude filled with glee? *(ROMEO grabs MONK LARRY's hand and gets down on one knee.)*

ROMEO: I need your consent, Monk, will you marry me? *(Monk Larry looks aghast)* No, No! There's a girl that I've met as of late, She is the daughter of Capitulate. Our love is true.

MONK LARRY. Are you sure?

ROMEO: Yes indeed. One-hundred and ninety percent guaranteed.

MONK LARRY: *(Aside to the audience)* If I marry the girl to this Monotone dude-ling, It may end the war, all this troublesome feud-ling. *(To ROMEO)* Okay, my young pup, I'll tie your knot, But, if you're eloping, then you'll need a plot.

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NARRATOR 1: Romy and J were now happily married, They both yelled "hurray," and then off they scurried. But not all was happy in this neighborhood, Mercutio and

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Tybalt were up to no good. *(MERCUTIO mimes fighting with an unseen TYBALT)*

ROMEO: (*ROMEO enters)* Hey guys! Quit fighting, 'cuz that's just as bad, As putting chameleons on top of plaid. *(MERCUTIO is stabbed in the chest and falls. Romeo reacts to Mercutio's fall)* Mercutio!

MERCUTIO: Romeo!

ROMEO: Friend, are you dying?

MERCUTIO: No, I'm feeling fine . . . and . . . I am lying. *(lets out a blood-curdling scream)*

(ROMEO pulls TYBALT's sword free. He stumbles backwards from the pull and kills TYBALT with his own weapon.)

TYBALT: With my own bumballoon, now I am slain!

ROMEO: *(ROMEO is stunned that he just killed TYBALT.)* What in the world? Crap! How did this happen? *(ROMEO exits.)*

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THE PRINCE: What happened here? I'd like to explore / The reason there's two dead guys here on the floor.

BENVOLIO: Tybalt here bumballooned good friend Mercutio, and then got his bell rung by poor, sweet, young Romeo.

LADY CAPITULATE: *(To the PRINCE)* My kinsman Tybalt lies dead on the floor. Romeo must die to even the score.

THE PRINCE: Easy there girly-girl! I call the shots. I am the prince here believe it or not. I'll banish young Romeo from fair Verona, As soon as I finish this slice of bologna.

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NARRATOR 1: Romeo has to go to skip town or else, The prince might find out and put him on the shelf. We see here young Julie as she thinks and sits,

JULIET: I'm wife to a banished guy. Man! That's the pits. I can't marry Paris, 'cuz I've got a husband. I'm sure that's illegal except in Wisconsin. I need to get help. If

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I don't, then I'm sunk. This is a job for old Larry the Monk. *(She arrives at Monk Larry's place)* Gentle Monk Larry, I need some assistance. My wedding's tomorrow despite my resistance. To Romeo, you'll recall, I am now wed. But, they'd have me wed Paris . . .

MONK LARRY: Not if you're dead. Listen, I've got a plan, but it takes guts, And you must eat two of these death faking nuts.

JULIET: How'll Romeo know that I'm not really croaked?

MONK LARRY: I'll send him an email, I'll tell him our joke.

NARRATOR 2: The monk sent his email with details attached But, Romeo missed it, 'cuz his PC crashed. *(Romeo mimes typing on a keyboard and reacts to the computer crashing)* He never learned Juliet was faking disaster.

NARRATOR 1: Later that night Juliet ate the nuts. *(JULIET eats the nuts looking around and chewing obnoxiously. Then, very suddenly, she falls over as if dead in her bed.)* Then in the morning, she wouldn't wake up. *(The NURSE enters and screams.)*

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NARRATOR 1: Meanwhile back on the beach of Kadid, We meet up with Romeo, that's where he hid.

BENVOLIO: Romeo wake up, and hear what I say, Juliet's dead and her funeral's today.

ROMEO: It must have been her broken heart that went "Crack!" I'll kiss her one last time. I must now go back! Then I'll consume this authentic death cracker. *(ROMEO holds up a single soda cracker.)* Off to Verona I go with my life, To lay it before my corpse of a wife. *(Romeo travels to Juliet's tomb)* Juliet, honey, to get here I ran. I tripped on a grave stone and fell on my can. I came here to give your lips just one more kiss, And then, when I'm done, I'm gonna eat this. *(He holds up the authentic death cracker dramatically.)* Here comes the kiss so pucker up sister. *(He kisses Juliet)* Yippee, yahoo! You're still a great kisser. That was phase one, now here comes phase two . . .

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(ROMEO holds the cracker up and makes a big production out of eating it. He assumes a safety position as if something is going to happen. It doesn't. He stands up straight and waits. He checks his watch. He whistles. The NARRATORS enter.)

NARRATOR 2: Now, there's a reason that Romeo's life isn't halting,

NARRATOR 1: 'Cuz we switched his death cracker with a plain saltine.

NARRATOR 2: We've read this show, and it don't end pretty,

NARRATOR 1: So we tweaked the plot a bit-made it less gritty.

NARRATOR 2: Juliet woke from her death grip like slumber, And overjoyed, Romeo did a back flip dance number. *(Romeo dances)*

NARRATOR 1: Mercutio and Tybalt weren't really dead, *(MERCUTIO and TYBALT enter.)*

TYBALT: We were just teasing, **MERCUTIO:** Playin' with your head.

NARRATOR 1: Long years of bitterness melted away.

NARRATOR 2: Now they had nothing but nice things to say.

CAPITULATE: Say! I like that tie.

MONOTONE. I like your trousers and ... you're a nice guy.

NARRATOR 1: It was official. The feuding had ended, The lovers kept loving and the families befriended.

NARRATOR 2: Now, you may have noticed that no one here died.

NARRATOR 1: What!? Can we help it if our prologue lied? But, come on! That's no way to end a good play.

NARRATOR 2: Dr. Seuss wouldn't I'd venture to say.

NARRATOR 1: That's right, he wouldn't, and neither would we, Even though our play is Dr. Seuss-free.

NARRATOR 2: We hope you've enjoyed this tragic lament.

NARRATOR 1: 'Cus we've all enjoyed it ...

BOTH: One-hundred percent!

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AWARD HISTORY

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